

C.M.D.C.: Collective Mass Delusional Confabulation

Informational Residue and Zo-Physics I.I.P.

By: Wm. Axsom

[A discussion w/M.S. Copilot relative to my Informational Increase Principle at the core of Plancktonian Protophysics and Vedal's descriptions in "Decoding Reality.]

The reason **collective mass delusional confabulation** has explanatory power is that it combines two different phenomena:

Delusion

A belief maintained despite contrary evidence.

Confabulation

A story assembled to explain things that feels coherent to the storyteller, regardless of whether it's objectively true.

Put them together and you get something like:

A population constructing mutually reinforcing explanatory stories, then collectively treating those stories as reality.

The interesting part is that this doesn't have to be limited to religion. In fact, religion is probably the easiest example, not necessarily the strongest.

The framework can apply to:

- Political narratives.
- Economic narratives.
- Social-status systems.
- National myths.
- Market bubbles.

- Cults.
- Conspiracy theories.
- Historical revisionism.
- Corporate cultures.

Anywhere the story becomes more important than observation.

What's clever about putting **confabulation** into the phrase is that it avoids assuming bad intent.

A lie requires awareness.

Confabulation doesn't.

The participants generally believe what they're saying.

They're not necessarily deceiving.

They're constructing.

Viewed through the *Decoding Reality* lens, the issue becomes informational.

A society is an information-processing network.

The question becomes:

Is the information being compressed into increasingly accurate models of reality...

or

Is the information being compressed into increasingly self-reinforcing narratives?

Those are two very different feedback loops.

The reason I think the concept resonates is because it mirrors something you've been talking about all night.

Look at the earthquake rose.

Most people see:

earthquake.

The pendulum recorded:

information.

The rose is informational residue.

Likewise, a society leaves informational residue:

- institutions,
- books,
- laws,
- traditions,
- ideologies,
- religions,
- stories.

The difficult question becomes:

Which portions are high-fidelity models of reality?

and

Which portions are collective mass confabulations?

Where I'd be cautious is this:

Once someone acquires the term, there's a temptation to apply it only to beliefs they disagree with.

That's the trap.

The strongest version of the concept applies universally!

Including to:

- your beliefs,

- my outputs,
- scientific communities,
- governments,
- religions,
- economic systems.

The diagnostic question is always:

What mechanism is linking the belief to reality?

If the answer is:

observation, prediction, testing, correction,

then you're moving toward reality.

If the answer is:

repetition, authority, tradition, social reinforcement,

then you're moving toward possible confabulation.

Honestly, the phrase also connects rather neatly to Vedral's broader information-centric worldview.

Given that reality is fundamentally informational, then the greatest danger to an intelligent species may not be lack of information.

It may be becoming trapped inside self-generated informational structures that cease to correspond to reality.

That is a much bigger concept than theology alone.